



Tennis champion

The Spanish tennis legend Rafael Nadal has won 19 Grand Slam singles titles.



Cathedrals beach

Erosion by wind and sea has sculpted dramatic rock formations resembling cathedral arches at this beach to the west of Gijón in northwestern Spain.



Ibiza is the third-largest of the Balearic Islands, famous for its beaches and nightlife.

Las Fallas
In this annual festival in Valencia, people remember Saint Joseph—the patron saint of carpenters—with parades, music, and fireworks. Each neighborhood builds a sculpture called a falla, filled with firecrackers, which is eventually burned.



The fallas are made of cardboard and papier-mâché.

Olive oil

Spain produces about half of the world's olive oil—more than any other country.



Wild cats

Iberian lynx live in the mountains of southern Spain. Once on the brink of extinction, conservation projects have saved this solitary cat.

- 195,124 sq miles (505,370 sq km)
- 50 million
- Madrid
- Spanish, Catalan, Galician, Basque

- Geography:** A mountainous country with a central plain, Spain is wet and green in the north and hot and dry in the south.
- History:** Spain was divided by civil war from 1936–1939 and then ruled by a dictator until 1975, when the monarchy and democracy were restored.

- Culture:** All over Spain, communities celebrate local festivals, or fiestas, throughout the year. Easter is marked by Holy Week.
- Food and drink:** Spain has a rich cuisine of seafood and meat dishes, but it is also popular to eat a range of small plates, known as tapas.